

Business Requirements Document (BRD)

Chief of Staff Platform

Version: 1.0

Target Organization: Small to Medium Business (up to approximately 100 employees)

1. Purpose

The Chief of Staff Platform is a lightweight Human Resources and Organizational Management application designed for organizations of up to 100 employees.

The application provides a single source of truth for the company's workforce while enabling leadership to visualize the organization, understand reporting relationships, manage basic employee information, and support workforce planning without the complexity of a full enterprise Human Capital Management (HCM) system.

The platform intentionally focuses on simplicity, ease of use, and rapid adoption.

2. Business Objectives

The application shall enable the organization to:

- Maintain a centralized directory of all employees and external workers.
 - Provide an always up-to-date organizational chart.
 - Clearly visualize departments, teams, and reporting lines.
 - Manage basic employment and contract information.
 - Track future hiring needs and vacant positions.
 - Estimate workforce costs by department.
 - Centralize employee-related documents.
 - Support simple approval workflows.
 - Allow leadership to quickly locate expertise within the company.
 - Produce standard workforce reports.
 - Export workforce data for external analysis.
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3. Scope

In Scope

The application shall include:

- Employee directory
 - Contractor directory
 - Organizational structure
 - Teams and departments
 - Position management
 - Open positions
 - Skills directory
 - Workforce cost estimation
 - Employee documents
 - Leave requests
 - Manager approvals
 - Standard dashboards
 - Data export
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Out of Scope

The following capabilities are explicitly excluded from the initial version:

- Payroll processing
 - Recruitment and Applicant Tracking (ATS)
 - Performance reviews
 - Learning Management
 - Compensation management
 - Benefits administration
 - Time tracking
 - Expense management
 - Multi-company support
 - Multi-country legislation
 - Accounting functionality
 - Electronic signatures
 - Advanced workflow engines
 - Custom report builders
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4. Users

The application supports four user roles.

Administrator

Responsible for application configuration, security, and overall administration.

Capabilities include:

- Full system access
 - User management
 - Configuration management
 - Reporting
 - Data import/export
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HR / Operations

Responsible for maintaining workforce information.

Capabilities include:

- Manage employee records
 - Manage contractors
 - Upload documents
 - Create future positions
 - Manage departments and teams
 - Generate reports
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Manager

Responsible for their direct reports.

Capabilities include:

- View team members
 - Approve requests
 - View organizational structure
 - Update limited employee information
 - Search workforce skills
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Employee

Capabilities include:

- View own profile
 - Update personal information (where permitted)
 - Submit leave requests
 - View organization chart
 - Search colleagues
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5. Functional Requirements

5.1 People Directory

The system shall maintain a centralized directory of all workers.

Each profile shall contain:

- Name
- Photograph
- Email
- Phone number
- Job title
- Department
- Team
- Manager
- Employment type
- Start date
- Status
- Office location (optional)

The system shall support both internal employees and external workers using a unified profile.

External workers shall additionally include:

- Supplier or agency
- Contract end date
- Daily or hourly rate

The directory shall support filtering and searching.

5.2 Organizational Structure

The system shall represent the company's organizational hierarchy.

The hierarchy shall consist of:

- Company
- Department
- Team

Each employee shall belong to one team.

Each team shall belong to one department.

Each employee shall have one direct manager.

The organizational chart shall be generated automatically from reporting relationships.

The organization chart shall support:

- Zoom
 - Pan
 - Search
 - Expand/collapse branches
 - Employee photographs
 - Display of vacant positions
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5.3 Positions

The application shall maintain organizational positions.

Each position shall include:

- Job title
- Department
- Team
- Employment type
- Status

Position status shall include:

- Filled
- Vacant
- Planned

Vacant positions shall appear in the organization chart.

5.4 Employment Information

Each worker shall have an employment record containing:

- Employment type
- Start date
- End date (if applicable)
- Manager
- Department
- Team
- Job title
- Status

Supported employment types include:

- Permanent
- Fixed-Term
- Contractor
- Intern

5.5 Skills Directory

Employees may maintain a list of professional skills.

Skills shall be searchable throughout the application.

Examples include:

- Python
- Java
- Sales
- Finance
- Design
- Project Management

Managers shall be able to locate employees based on skills.

5.6 Workforce Cost

The application shall provide workforce cost visibility.

Each employee may include:

- Annual salary

Each contractor may include:

- Daily rate
- Hourly rate

The system shall estimate workforce costs by:

- Department
- Team
- Employment type

The system is intended for planning purposes only and shall not replace payroll software.

5.7 Documents

Each employee profile shall support document storage.

Supported document categories include:

- Employment contract
- NDA
- Work permit

- Visa
- Certification
- Other HR documents

Documents shall be securely stored and accessible according to user permissions.

5.8 Leave Requests

Employees shall be able to submit leave requests.

Managers shall approve or reject requests.

Each request shall include:

- Leave type
- Start date
- End date
- Comment

Approval shall consist of a single manager validation step.

5.9 Notifications

The application shall notify users when:

- Leave approval is required
- Leave is approved or rejected
- A contract is approaching expiration
- A new employee joins
- A planned position reaches its target start date

Notifications shall be delivered inside the application.

5.10 Reporting

The application shall provide standard dashboards including:

- Total headcount
- Employees versus contractors
- Open positions
- Department headcount
- Workforce cost by department
- Seniority distribution
- New hires
- Departures
- Skills overview

Users shall be able to export reports to Excel or CSV.

5.11 Global Search

The application shall provide a single search interface capable of locating:

- Employees
- Contractors
- Departments
- Teams
- Managers
- Job titles
- Skills
- Email addresses

Search results shall be returned instantly.

6. Configuration

The application shall allow administrators to configure:

- Departments
- Teams
- Job titles
- Employment types
- Cost centers
- Leave types
- Skill categories
- Custom employee fields
- Approval delegates

Configuration shall not require software development.

7. Security

Authentication shall integrate with the organization's identity provider.

Supported providers include:

- Microsoft 365
- Google Workspace

The application shall support role-based permissions.

Access shall be restricted according to user role.

Employee documents shall only be visible to authorized users.

8. Audit History

The application shall maintain an audit history for significant changes.

Changes to the following information shall be recorded:

- Manager
- Department
- Team
- Job title
- Employment type
- Status

Each audit record shall contain:

- Date
 - User
 - Previous value
 - New value
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9. Non-Functional Requirements

The application shall:

- Support approximately 100 active users.
 - Be accessible through modern web browsers.
 - Provide a responsive user interface.
 - Load common pages in less than two seconds.
 - Automatically save changes where appropriate.
 - Support CSV and Excel import/export.
 - Maintain daily backups.
 - Protect personal information through role-based access control.
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10. Success Criteria

The project shall be considered successful when:

- The organization chart accurately reflects the current organization.
- All employees and contractors are maintained in a single directory.
- Leadership can identify reporting relationships within seconds.
- HR can manage workforce information without spreadsheets.
- Managers can approve leave requests digitally.

- Workforce costs can be viewed by department.
 - Leadership can export organizational data on demand.
 - The application is adopted as the company's primary organizational directory.
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11. Future Enhancements

The architecture should allow future expansion without major redesign.

Potential future capabilities include:

- Payroll integration
- Recruitment management
- Performance reviews
- Learning management
- Employee onboarding workflows
- Equipment and asset management
- Project allocation
- API integrations
- Advanced analytics
- Mobile application